



September 22, 2025

RE: Support for Village of Saranac Lake Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

On behalf of the Saranac Lake Central School District, I am pleased to express our strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant application to fund contractual services for the Lake Colby Beach House accessibility upgrades.

Lake Colby Beach is an invaluable community resource for our students and their families. Each summer, youth from across our district rely on the beach for recreation, swimming lessons, and outdoor activities that build lifelong skills and confidence. However, the existing facilities create barriers for children and families with mobility challenges, preventing them from fully and safely using this public space.

Although we live in a region blessed with many lakes and rivers, the rugged terrain makes most of these places inaccessible for anyone with even moderate mobility issues. Lake Colby Beach is the only publicly accessible beach within walking distance of our Village. Yet, as it currently stands, it is not fully inclusive, leaving some of our neighbors, friends, and students unable to participate in one of the central recreational and social activities of our area.

With this grant, the Village will be able to contract professional services, including engineering, architectural, and construction expertise, to design and deliver ADA-compliant bathrooms, safe pathways, and lifeguard facilities. These improvements will ensure that Lake Colby Beach is not only more inclusive for children with disabilities, but also safer and better equipped to serve the hundreds of local students who enjoy it each year.

Investing in the accessibility of Lake Colby Beach is an investment in equity, wellness, and the quality of life within the community. We strongly urge your support of this proposal.

Sincerely,

Diane Fox
Superintendent of Schools

